



# City Council: 2nd Finance Meeting October 5, 2022

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=acs4Pw07H3w">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=acs4Pw07H3w</a> |
| Publication Date | 2022-11-02T14:04:26Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## Municipal Meeting Summary Report

**Meeting:** 2023 Municipal Budget Review - Session 2

**Body:** City Council

### 1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

*(Not applicable <U+2013> No separate statutory public hearings or committee sessions were held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order.)*

### 2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:00:47 Presiding Officer President Robinson called the meeting to order, welcoming attendees to the second scheduled meeting to review the proposed 2023 municipal budget.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Presiding Officer:** President Robinson
  - **Members Present:** Councilman Ingram, Councilman Garrett (or similar phonetic spelling), Councilman Overby, Councilman Dishman, Councilman Green, Councilman Polk, Councilman Clark, Councilwoman Selby, and President Robinson (9 council members present, establishing a full board).

- **Members Absent:** None noted.
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### 3. Procedural Business

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- **Ceremonial Openings:** 00:00:26 The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Rick Insert.
  - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not addressed in the transcript segment provided.)*
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### 4. Substantive Business & Board Action

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#### 00:01:39 2023 Municipal Budget Review: Street Department

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Leach, Superintendent / Department Head.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Mr. Leach provided a department overview noting 22 budgeted personnel managing 766 lane miles (314 road miles).
  - Achievements included closing 104 work orders, 1,171 patches, 400 feet of concrete repairs, maintaining 82 signals, spending 1,320 hours on mowing/weeding, removing 89 trees, and generating \$150,000 in revenue via an agreement with the Muncie Sanitary District (MSD).
  - First-time utilization of bag mix in winter proved more efficient, and the department conducted in-house milling/paving.
  - Budget changes include adding one working foreman (flat organization structure adjustment) and one equipment operator (reducing a truck driver position). Training budgets increase for OSHA, weed control spraying, and compliance with the Federal Motor Carriers Act entry-level driver training (costing ~\$5,000 per person if outsourced).
  - Council members caught and discussed several line item discrepancies (e.g., road salt and signal electrician lines showing \$0 due to administrative carryover issues). It was determined that these would be corrected via an additional appropriation in January.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Budget review only; no final adoption vote taken during this budget work session.

#### 00:01:59 2023 Municipal Budget Review: Police Department

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Deputy Chief Deegan.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Deputy Chief Deegan presented highlights, noting the completion of a \$300,000 Motorola Radio project, acquisition of 11 new vehicles and 20 new laptops, and a

new 5-year agreement with Axon which replaced 70 aging tasers and expanded body-worn cameras.

- A new 24/7 on-site training center saves the agency \$5,000 annually. A new online recruitment process and Ball State/Ivy Tech internship program have helped bring staffing to 103 officers, with potential recruits in background checks aiming for full staffing.
- Budget increases include a shift of civilian PERF back to the general fund (sworn personnel PERF remains in Fund 106), a 2% city-wide salary increase, psychological services (\$20,000 increase for wellness/EAP utilization), equipment repair/maintenance, body-worn camera contract expansion, and cell phone/technology line items (\$30,000 increase) tied to evidentiary data collection.
- Discussed fleet status: over 40 hybrid or Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) response vehicles are in service, helping manage fuel costs, though CNG parts availability and maintenance present ongoing operational bottlenecks.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Budget review only; no final adoption vote taken.

#### 00:04:54 2023 Municipal Budget Review: Fire Department & EMS

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Mead.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Chief Mead reported that the department is on course to make 18,000 runs in 2023. Key updates include the acquisition of 7 Ford Explorer staff vehicles, a new ambulance, 50 new radios (awaiting secondary battery shipments), and new MDTs (iPads using Crewforce).
  - The civilian paramedic program established in January is functioning with 11 civilian paramedics.
  - Budget changes include a jump in software maintenance agreements from \$2,500 to \$62,000 to implement the ESO reporting system (replacing the defunct Firehouse software and ImageTrend), increased gas/oil costs for gasoline-engine ambulances, medical supply cost increases (\$225,000 to \$354,000), building maintenance/repairs (\$0 to \$70,000 to address station roofs, leaks, and mold), and a bond/lien line increase (\$0 to \$100,000).
  - Secured an unallocated fire engine build slot (Cummins engine, Allison transmission) through a canceled customer order, utilizing EMS revenue monies.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
  - **01:01:31** Former newsman/author: Inquired about total employed firefighters, civilian paramedics, EMT numbers, and ALS/BLS ambulance staffing status. Chief Mead responded that the department has 110 firefighters and 11 civilian paramedics (moving toward 12), with 3-5 ALS ambulances staffed on duty daily.

- **01:02:55** Mr. Gilbert: Inquired about the employment classification and union representation of civilian paramedics. Chief Mead and President Robinson clarified that civilian paramedics are non-union city employees governed by the city employee handbook.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Budget review only; no final adoption vote taken.

#### **01:04:47 2023 Municipal Budget Review: Police and Fire Merit Commissions**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Mead & Deputy Chief Deegan.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - The presiding officer noted that the Merit Commission budgets remain essentially unchanged with no personnel line items subject to the 2% raise. Funds support hiring processes, commission secretaries, and legal services.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Budget review only; no final adoption vote taken.

#### **01:05:25 2023 Municipal Budget Review: Animal Shelter**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Miss Wolf (Shelter Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Miss Wolf highlighted staff retention and workload (managing 30<U+2013>44 animals per staff member daily, averaging 350 animals per day at the shelter). The shelter still requires 3 part-time Animal Control Officers (ACOs).
  - An inter-local agreement with the county requires presenting budget differences to the County Council to cover county animal services.
  - Inflationary pressures have driven up food (\$2,200/month) and litter (\$3,000/month) expenses, as well as veterinary/medical care costs (e.g., treating 22 dogs for heartworms this year).
  - Council members expressed strong concern that the shelter relies heavily on community donations and asked why the director did not request a higher budget allocation, affirming their full support for fully funding animal care needs without forcing staff to fundraise.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Budget review only; no final adoption vote taken.

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## **5. Ordinances & Resolutions (Introduction & Suspension of Rules)**

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- **01:16:02 Procedural Motion: Suspension of Rules for Salary Ordinances**
  - **Presenter:** President Robinson
  - **Deliberation Summary:** The council considered four salary ordinances introduced on Monday, required to be passed in tandem with the budget by November 1st. A

motion was made and seconded to suspend the rules to consider the introduction of all four ordinances simultaneously.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (9-0: Ingram-Yes, Garrett-Yes, Overby-Yes, Dishman-Yes, Green-Yes, Polk-Yes, Clark-Yes, Selby-Yes, Robinson-Yes).
- **01:17:34 Ordinance 36-22: Elected Officials Salary Ordinance**
  - **Description:** Fixing the salaries for all elected officials of the City of Muncie, Indiana, for the year 2023.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via motion by Councilman Green, seconded by Councilman Ingram. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:18:34 Ordinance 37-22: Police Department Salary Ordinance**
  - **Description:** Fixing the maximum salaries of each and every member of the Muncie Police Department for the year 2023.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via motion by Councilwoman Selvey, seconded by Councilman Polk. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:19:13 Ordinance 38-22: Fire Department Salary Ordinance**
  - **Description:** Fixing the maximum salaries of each and every member of the Muncie Fire Department for the year 2023.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via motion by Councilman Polk, seconded by Councilman Ingram. Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:20:14 Ordinance 39-22: Civil City Appointed Officers & Employees Salary Ordinance**
  - **Description:** Fixing the maximum salaries of each and every appointed officer, employee, deputy, assistant, departmental, and institutional head of the City of Muncie for the year 2023.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Introduced via motion by Councilman Overby, seconded by Councilman Ingram. Approved by Voice Vote.

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## 6. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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*(Note: General public comments occurred item-by-item during departmental reviews; no separate end-of-meeting open citizen forum was conducted.)*

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## 7. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **01:21:16** President Robinson congratulated Councilman Dishman on celebrating his 49th work anniversary at Pepsi.
- **Adjournment:** **01:21:45** Official motion to adjourn made by Councilman Polk, seconded by Councilman Overby. Approved by Voice Vote.

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